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E2 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 11: Listening to everyday conversations – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to work out where a conversation happens and who is speaking, follow a change of plan, and answer a yes/no and a detail question about a short dialogue. This prepares the dialogues in Task 4.

Materials: Handout E2-11A, one per learner. The teacher's scripts below. If a colleague or a strong learner can read the second voice, use them. If not, turn your body and change your voice for each speaker.

Activity 1: Where are they? (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Read six opening lines, one at a time. After each, learners say where the speakers are and who they are: "Next, please. Are you paying by card?" "Take a seat. The doctor will call you." "Is this seat free?" "Have you got your student card?" "Eat in or take away?" "Return or single?"
2. For each, ask which words gave the answer. Board them under place names: *shop, surgery, bus or train, college, café, station*.
3. Explain why this matters: once you know the place, you can guess what people will say, and the listening becomes easier.
4. Pairs think of one more typical line for each place. Hear several and let the class guess the place.

Activity 2: Change of plan (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Recall the warning words from Lesson 10. In conversations the change is softer. Board the phrases: *I'd love to, but… Can we make it…? Actually… I'm sorry, we've run out of… What about…?*
2. Read this short exchange twice: "Shall we meet at two?" "Can we make it three? I need to cook first." "Three is fine." Ask what time they will meet and how learners know. The last agreed detail is the answer.
3. Give four more mini exchanges orally and ask for the final plan each time. Vary the detail: a day, a place, a food, a price.
4. Drill the phrases. Learners will need them in their own speaking too.

Activity 3: Two conversations (30 minutes)

1. Read the questions for Conversation 1 in section A of the handout together. Learners predict the place.
2. Read Script A twice. First time for the yes/no question, answered aloud together. Second time for the details, written on the handout.
3. Check. Ask how many tablets the customer can take in one day. This needs careful listening for *eight*.
4. Repeat with Script B. Ask why the answer to the time question is three and not two.
5. Pairs compare and then answer aloud in full sentences.

Activity 4: Exam mode (20 minutes)

1. Pairs, A and B. Read Script C twice. As answer the yes/no question in a whisper to their partner; Bs answer the detail question. Confirm aloud.
2. Read Script D twice. Swap roles.
3. Ask the class what the trap was in Script D. The customer asked for cheese and did not get it.
4. Three pairs give their answers to the class as full sentences.

Activity 5: Act it and discuss it (30 minutes)

1. Give out section B of the handout: the four conversations as prompts only. Pairs choose one and rebuild it from memory, changing any details they like.

2. Pairs perform for another pair, who answer one yes/no question and one detail question set by the performers.
3. Then the four learners discuss the matching question from section C for two minutes, as in the discussion at the end of Task 4.
4. Two groups perform for the class.
5. Close: learners tell a partner the three things to listen for in a conversation: the place, the people, the final detail.

Teacher's scripts

Script A (pharmacy).

- A: Hello. Can I help?
- B: Yes. I've got a bad headache. Have you got anything for it?
- A: Have you taken anything today?
- B: No, nothing.
- A: These tablets are good. Take two now and two more after four hours. Don't take more than eight in one day.
- B: OK. How much are they?
- A: One pound twenty.
- Yes/no: Has the customer got a stomach ache? (No, she hasn't. She has a headache.)
- Detail: How many tablets does she take now? (Two.) How much are they? (One pound twenty.)

Script B (two friends).

- A: Do you want to go to the park on Sunday?
- B: I'd love to, but I'm busy in the morning.
- A: What about the afternoon? Two o'clock?
- B: Can we make it three? I need to cook lunch first.
- A: Three is fine. Shall we meet at the gate?
- B: Yes. I'll bring some tea.
- Yes/no: Are they going to meet in the morning? (No, they aren't.)
- Detail: What time are they going to meet? (Three o'clock.) Where? (At the gate.)

Script C (college reception).

- A: Good morning. I'd like to join an English class.
- B: Of course. Have you studied here before?
- A: No, this is my first time.
- B: OK. You need to do a short test first. We have tests on Wednesday at ten or Friday at one.
- A: Wednesday, please.
- B: Fine. Please bring some ID and come to Room 3.
- Yes/no: Has the student studied at the college before? (No, he hasn't.)
- Detail: Which day is his test? (Wednesday.)

Script D (café).

- A: What would you like?
- B: A cheese sandwich and a tea, please.
- A: I'm sorry, we've run out of cheese. We've got egg or chicken.
- B: Egg, please.
- A: Eat in or take away?
- B: Take away.
- A: That's four pounds fifty.
- Yes/no: Does the customer get a cheese sandwich? (No, she doesn't.)
- Detail: How much does she pay? (Four pounds fifty.)

Answer key, Lesson 11

- **Section A:** as shown under Scripts A and B.